

B.T. Franklin

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Professional Summary

Applied AI technical lead and software architect with 20+ years building enterprise software, developer tools, and product-facing systems. Combines hands-on agentic AI, platform architecture, full-stack engineering, technical leadership, and published computational creativity research.

Professional Experience

Zilliant, Inc.

AI Tech Lead / Staff Software Engineer

April 2025 - July 2026

- Guided engineering teams on LLMs, agents, evaluation practices, and modern AI development aligned with business goals.
- Architected and shipped a customer-facing read-only data API in less than one month, earning a delivery bonus; then refactored Pricing Plus data access behind semantic adapters.
- Led and prototyped an AWS offering built with the Strands Agents SDK for conversational exploration of pricing formulas.
- Architected the company's first MCP server and tools for retrieving calculated prices and explaining formula reasoning.
- Expanded AI-assisted engineering through Codex training, reusable review skills, and agent-guided development workflows.

Software Architect

August 2022 - March 2025

- Built a generative AI pipeline that integrated diverse pricing insights into customer-facing analytics in real time.
- Led and shipped an AWS QuickSight and Amazon Q integration with embedded visualization and AI-assisted analysis.
- Designed and launched the Zilliant Developer Experience CLI, reducing complex environment migrations from multiple days to a few hours.

- **Earlier Zilliant progression (2009-2022):** Staff Software Engineer (2020-2022) and Senior Software Engineer (2009-2019), spanning architecture, product modernization, and mentorship.

Founder-Led and Open Source AI Work

- **RepoZest:** Built and deployed a GitHub App-backed repository intelligence SaaS for architecture, expertise, hotspots, ownership risk, and AI reports; later sunset and open-sourced.
- **Hiredar:** Built and deployed an AI recruiting SaaS with OpenAI extraction, embeddings, Pinecone, RAG-based matching, background workers, Stripe, and recruiter-facing UI.
- **Open source AI tooling:** Created contract4agents, agentic-django, compendiumscribe, promptdown, release-notes-scribe, and reusable agent skills.

Research and Publications

Published computational creativity research on AI-driven storytelling and generative music in the *Proceedings of Generative Art Conference* and *Computer Simulation of Musical Creativity Conference*.

Education

Transylvania University, Lexington, KY: BA in Computer Science, 1997.

Skills

Python; JavaScript/TypeScript; OpenAI and Anthropic APIs; Agentic Systems; MCP; RAG; Strands and OpenAI Agents SDKs; AWS; Django; React; Next.js; Node.js; API and Platform Design; Evaluation; Technical Strategy.